

BUDDY'S COMMANDER DECK

How to Play VENOM

Commander for total beginners



Eddie Brock → Venom, Lethal Protector

Jund · Black / Red / Green · 100 cards

A kid-friendly guide to Magic's Commander format
using Buddy's VENOM deck

What is Magic?

Five sentences. That's it.

- 1 Magic is a card game. You cast spells and creatures.
- 2 Lands make mana. Mana is fuel for cards.
- 3 Creatures fight. Spells help or hurt.
- 4 You win when others hit 0 life. They start at 40 in Commander.
- 5 Your graveyard is the used-card pile. This deck loves that pile.

Where your cards live (kid words)

LIBRARY

Your face-down deck

HAND

Cards you can play

BATTLEFIELD

Stuff in play

GRAVEYARD

Used / dead pile ★

VENOM loves this zone!

What is Commander?

The big multiplayer way to play

- Commander is multiplayer Magic.
- You use one 100-card deck.
- One special creature sits outside as your commander. Yours is Eddie Brock.
- You can cast him from that zone again and again.
- Everyone plays against everyone. Be nice. Have fun.

40 LIFE

Everyone starts at 40 in Commander



You Eddie Brock
Commander

How this deck wins

Play like Venom

1. GROW MANA

Early: elves, Sol Ring, Farseek, Cultivate.

2. FILL THE GRAVEYARD

Next: Stitcher's Supplier (and friends).

3. BRING MONSTERS BACK

Then: Reanimate big threats from the dead.

4. EDDIE → VENOM

Cast Eddie (free tiny creature). Transform. Attack and sac for cards.

5. PROTECT & FINISH

Protect, then smash with Ghalta, drain with Kokusho, or clear with Blasphemous Act.



Sol Ring



Stitcher's Supplier



Reanimate



Ghalta, Primal Hunger

Turn order

Every turn follows these steps

1

Untap

Wake up your cards.

2

Upkeep

Some cards do stuff here.

3

Draw

Take one card.

4

Main 1

Play a land (once), cast spells, cast Eddie if you want.

5

Combat

Attackers, blockers, damage.

6

Main 2

More spells if you have mana.

7

End

Cleanup. Next player's turn.

First 3 turns

Lands and mana first. Cool monsters second.

TURN 1

Land. If you have Llanowar Elves, Elvish Mystic, or Sol Ring, play it.



Llanowar Elves



Sol Ring

TURN 2

Land. More cheap mana. Stitcher's Supplier to fill the graveyard.



Sakura-Tribe Elder



Stitcher's Supplier

TURN 3

Land. Farseek / Cultivate / Nature's Lore. Keep protect mana if needed.



Cultivate



Farseek

Eddie transforms

Your commander's big trick



Eddie transforms into Venom, Lethal Protector.

Transform cost: {3}{B}{R}{G}

Pay 3 + black + red + green. Activate only as a sorcery — on your turn, in a main phase (not during combat).

Venom side (after transform)

Menace

Needs two blockers.

Trample

Extra damage spills past blockers.

Haste

Can attack the turn he transforms.

When Venom attacks

You may sacrifice another creature. If you do: draw X cards, then you may put a permanent with mana value X or less from your hand onto the battlefield. X = the sacrificed creature's mana value. (Big sac = big draw + free permanent!)

Avoid

- Don't transform with an empty hand — you need cards to cheat in.
- Don't cast Eddie with an empty graveyard — you miss the free tiny creature.
- Anger needs a Mountain in play to give haste from the graveyard.

When to cast Eddie

Timing + commander tax

CAST when...

You have a mana-value-1-or-less creature in the graveyard to return, and you can protect him.

WAIT when...

The graveyard has nothing useful, or the table can kill him with no backup.

Commander tax

Each time you recast Eddie from the command zone, he costs +2 mana.

1st cast

3 mana

+

2nd cast

+2 → 5

+

3rd cast

+2 → 7

+

4th cast

+2 → 9



Eddie Brock

Protect your creatures

Don't let them die for free

1. Feign Death / Malakir Rebirth / Not Dead After All — save one creature.
2. Heroic Intervention — protect your whole team for a turn.
3. Lightning Greaves — haste + shroud (hard to target).
4. Deflecting Swat — often free if you control your commander. Redirect a spell.
5. Kokusho dying is still good (he drains life).
6. Blasphemous Act if the board is full, then reanimate yours.

Deflecting Swat tip

Often free if you control your commander. Otherwise it costs {2}{R}.

Protection toolbox



Heroic Intervention



Feign Death



Lightning Greaves



Deflecting Swat

Finishers

How VENOM closes the game



Ghalta, Primal Hunger

Huge trampler. Costs less when your creatures are big.



Gwenom, Remorseless

Venom theme friend — pressure and aggression.



Kokusho, the Evening Star

When he dies, each opponent loses 5 life — you gain that much.



Venom, Deadly Devourer

Namesake threat. Eat and grow.



Blasphemous Act

Cheap board wipe when lots of creatures are out. Then reanimate yours.

10 words to know

Say these at the table

Mana

Fuel from lands (and rocks). You spend it to cast cards.

Ramp

Getting extra mana early (elves, Sol Ring, Cultivate).

Mill

Putting cards from a library into a graveyard.

Reanimate

Bringing a creature back from the graveyard to play.

Haste

Creature can attack (or tap) the turn it enters.

Trample

Extra combat damage spills over blockers to the player.

Menace

Must be blocked by two or more creatures.

Transform

Flip Eddie into Venom by paying {3}{B}{R}{G} as a sorcery.

Blocker

A creature you tap to stop an attacker.

Commander tax

+2 mana each time you recast your commander.

Sample turns

A strong keep and how it plays

Opening hand idea

Forest, Swamp, Sol Ring, Elvish Mystic, Sakura-Tribe Elder, Heroic Intervention, Stitcher's Supplier.

Turn 1

Forest → Elvish Mystic (or Llanowar Elves).

Turn 2

Swamp → Sol Ring → Stitcher's Supplier (mill 3; stock MV ≤ 1 targets).

Turn 3

Land → Sakura-Tribe Elder; sac Elder for a Mountain / Swamp / Forest. Keep Intervention up.

Turn 4–5

More ramp. Cast Eddie when a MV ≤ 1 creature is in the graveyard → free reanimation.

Turn 6+

Pay {3}{B}{R}{G} to transform. Attack as Venom; sac a creature for draw + free permanent.



Common mistakes

Avoid these — save games

Don't transform empty-handed

Venom's attack wants cards in hand to cheat in.

Don't cast Eddie with empty GY

You miss the free mana-value-1 creature.

Anger needs a Mountain

Anger in the graveyard only gives haste if you control a Mountain. (You have Mountain ×4.)

Sneak Attack end-step sac

The cheated creature dies at the next end step unless you save it.

Reanimate costs life

You lose life equal to the creature's mana value.

Don't dump Ghalta / Hulk open

Wait for Greaves, Intervention, Feign Death, or Swat.

Deflecting Swat is free only with commander

No commander out? It costs {2}{R}.

Watch commander tax

Each recast from the command zone costs +2 more mana.



Quick reference

Cheat sheet — keep this page open

Goal

Everyone else to 0 life (start at 40).

Colors

Black / Red / Green (Jund). Commander: Eddie → Venom.

Game plan

Ramp → fill GY → Eddie → transform → attack-sac → finish.

Transform

{3}{B}{R}{G} as a sorcery (main phase). Menace, trample, haste.

Early turns

Land + mana (Elves / Sol Ring). Then Supplier / Farseek / Cultivate.

Cast Eddie when

Tiny creature ($MV \leq 1$) in GY + protection ready.

Protect

Feign Death · Heroic Intervention · Greaves · Deflecting Swat (often free)

Finish

Ghalta smash · Kokusho drain · Blasphemous Act + reanimate

Remember

Lands & mana first. Don't transform empty-handed. Have fun.

Sources

Where this guide came from

Deck list (Archidekt)

<https://archidekt.com/decks/16672001/venom>

Card images (Scryfall)

<https://scryfall.com> — official card database & art

Rules concepts

Wizards of the Coast — Magic: The Gathering basic rules

Format

Commander (EDH) — 100 cards, 40 life, one commander

This PDF

Personal learning guide for Buddy's VENOM deck. Not for sale.

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